Project Report

Streamlining IT Procurement:

Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Platform	ServiceNow (Flow Designer, Service Catalog)
Program	SmartInternz / SmartBridge
Team ID	SWTID-2026-6870
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Date	04 October 2026

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1. Introduction

1.1 Project Overview

In many organisations the IT procurement process for standard laptops is slow and manual. After a laptop request is approved, someone has to create a configuration task and assign it to the hardware team. This step is easy to miss or delay, which frustrates users and wastes IT resources.

This project uses ServiceNow **Flow Designer** to automate that step. A flow named "Standard laptop task" is triggered from the Service Catalog and uses the **Create Catalog Task** action to create a task with the short description "Laptop needs to Configured", assignment group **Hardware** and approval **Approved**. The flow is attached to the **Standard Laptop** catalog item, so every order produces the task automatically.

1.2 Purpose

- Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
- Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
- Improve resource utilisation in the IT department by optimising task allocation.
- Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

2. Ideation Phase

2.1 Problem Statement

Standard laptop orders need configuration, but the configuration task is created and assigned manually and is often missed or delayed. Three users are affected: the IT procurement team member, the employee who requested the laptop, and the Hardware team member who configures it. The detailed statements (PS-1 to PS-3) are in the Define Problem Statements document.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

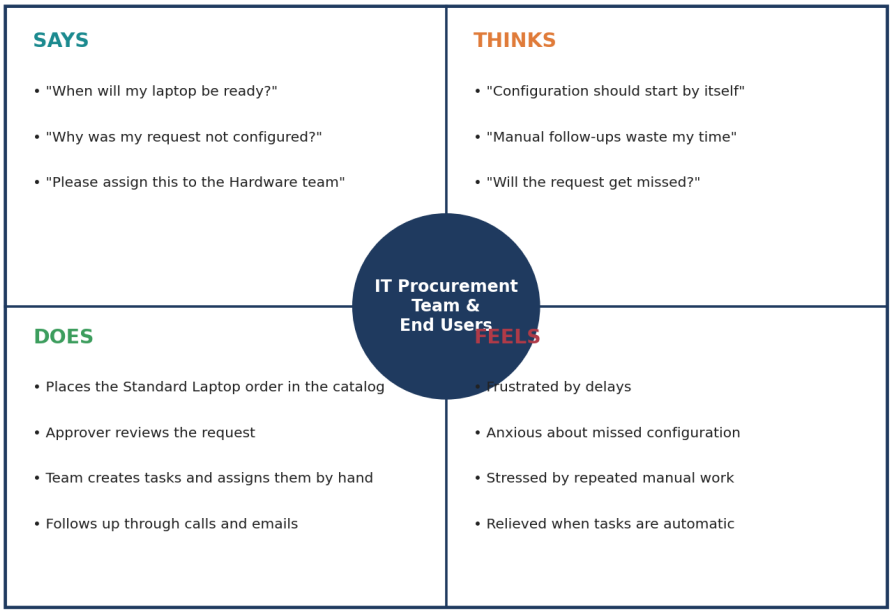


Figure 2.1: Empathy map

2.3 Brainstorming

The team listed ideas under automation, assignment, approval and tracking, and communication, then ranked them by impact and effort. The top ideas selected were the Flow Designer flow, automatic task creation, automatic assignment to Hardware and keeping the approval step.

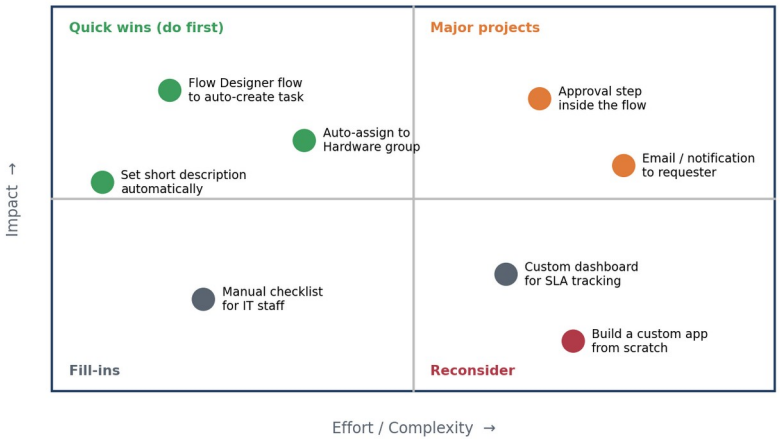


Figure 2.2: Idea prioritisation

3. Requirement Analysis

3.1 Customer Journey Map

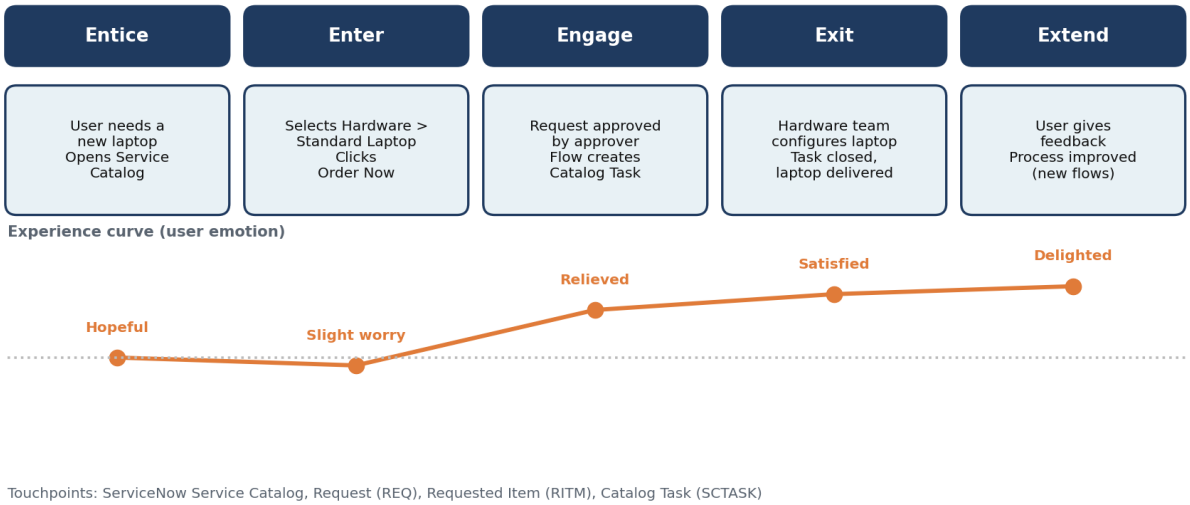


Figure 3.1: Customer journey map

3.2 Solution Requirement

Functional requirements: flow creation, Service Catalog trigger, Create Catalog Task action with field values, activation and assignment to the catalog item, ordering and approval, and verification of the generated task. Non-functional requirements: usability, security, reliability, performance, availability and scalability (see the Solution Requirements document).

3.3 Data Flow Diagram

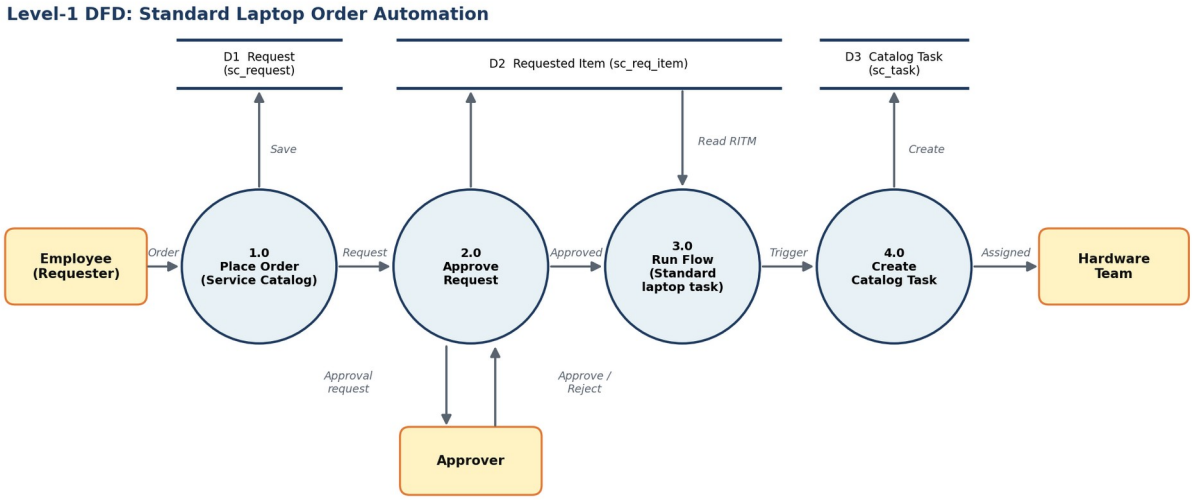


Figure 3.2: Level-1 data flow diagram

3.4 Technology Stack

Component	Technology
User interface	ServiceNow Service Catalog and platform forms
Application logic	Flow Designer flow with Service Catalog trigger; Create Catalog Task action
Database	ServiceNow tables sc_request, sc_req_item, sc_task
Hosting	ServiceNow cloud instance (Global scope)

4. Project Design

4.1 Problem Solution Fit

The problem is the missing link between an approved order and the Hardware team's configuration work. The solution fits the customers' behaviour because requesters keep using the Service Catalog and the flow works silently in the background, removing the need for manual task creation.

4.2 Proposed Solution

A low-code Flow Designer flow that creates a catalog task assigned to the Hardware group for every Standard Laptop order. It is novel in its simplicity, needs no scripting, and can be reused for other catalog items.

4.3 Solution Architecture

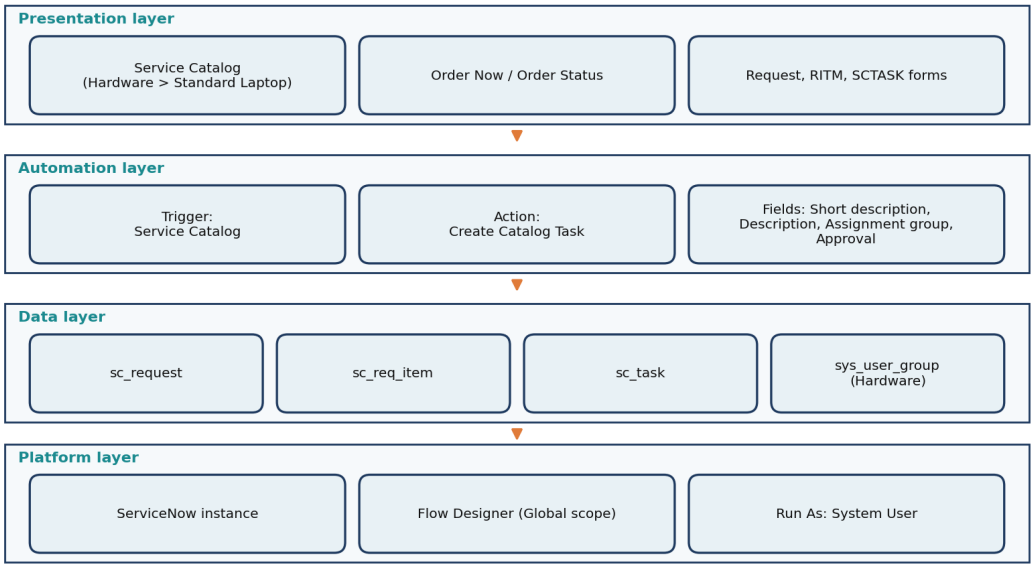


Figure 4.1: Solution architecture

5. Project Planning & Scheduling

5.1 Project Planning

The work was planned in two sprints. Sprint-1 (9 story points) covered flow creation and flow assignment. Sprint-2 (12 story points) covered ordering, approval, task verification, testing and documentation. Total scope was 21 story points with an average velocity of 10.5 story points per sprint.

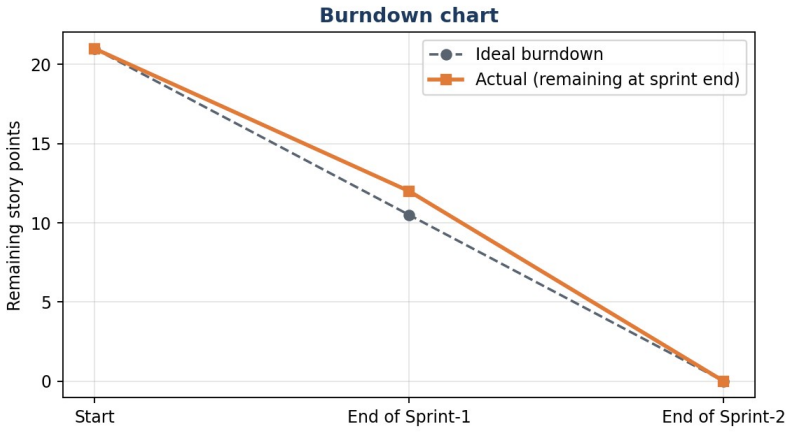


Figure 5.1: Burndown chart

6. Functional and Performance Testing

6.1 Performance Testing

Eleven test cases were defined: nine functional tests and two performance tests. Ten passed and one (multiple simultaneous orders) was not executed. No failures were recorded.

ID	Scenario	Result	Evidence
FT-01–04	Flow creation, trigger, action, activation	Pass	Flow Designer screens
FT-05	Flow assignment to Standard Laptop	Pass	Process Engine tab

ID	Scenario	Result	Evidence
FT-06–07	Order placement and approval	Pass	REQ0010001, approver record
FT-08–09	Catalog task generated with correct values	Pass	SCTASK0010001
PT-01	Task creation time	Pass	Order 04:07:11; task start 04:11:40
PT-02	Multiple simultaneous orders	Not tested	–

7. Results

7.1 Output Screenshots

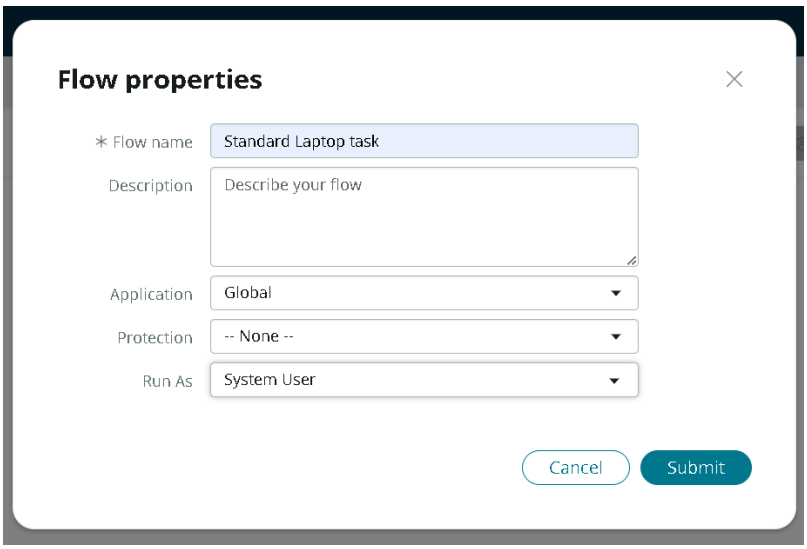


Figure 7.1: Flow properties – Standard Laptop task

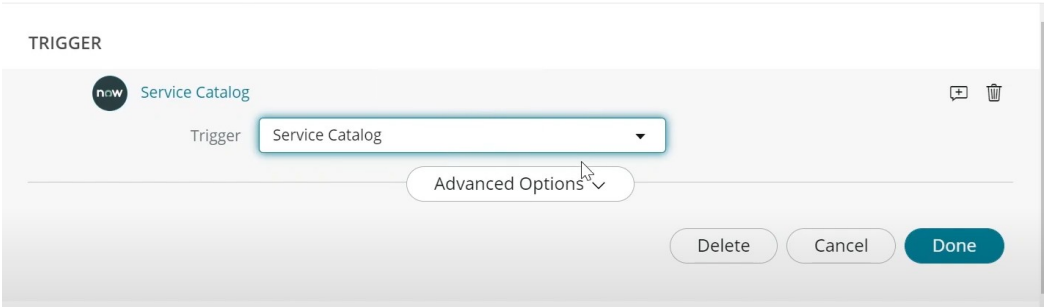


Figure 7.2: Service Catalog trigger

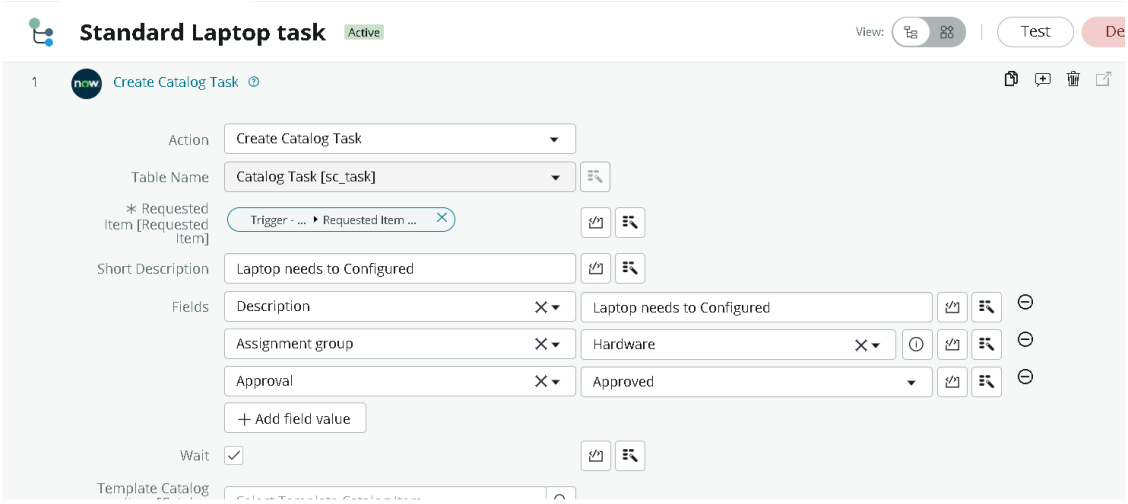


Figure 7.3: Create Catalog Task action

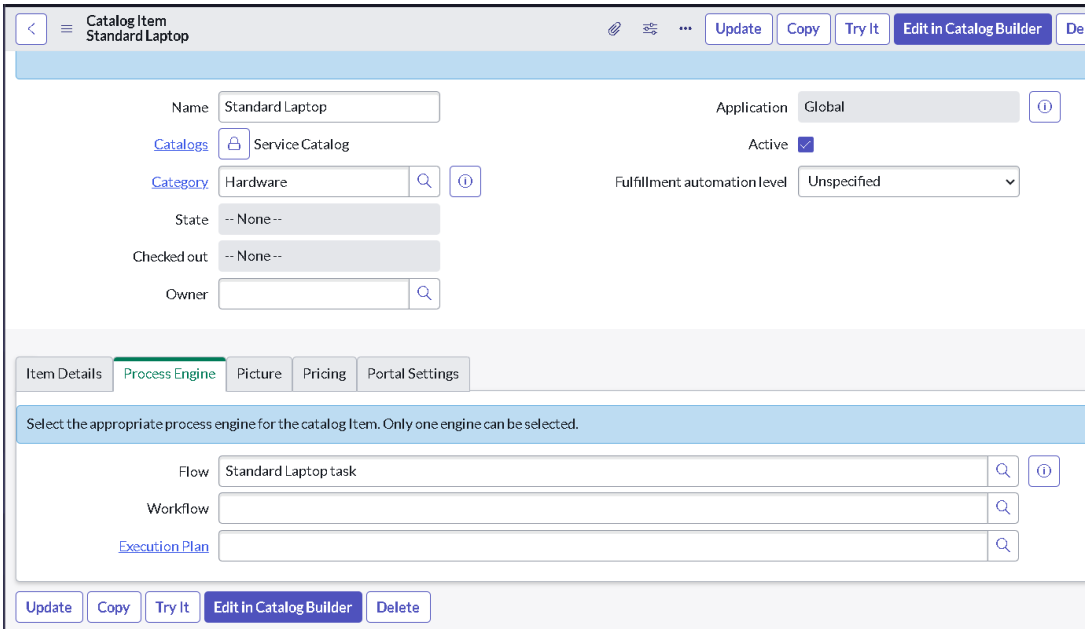


Figure 7.4: Flow attached to Standard Laptop in Process Engine

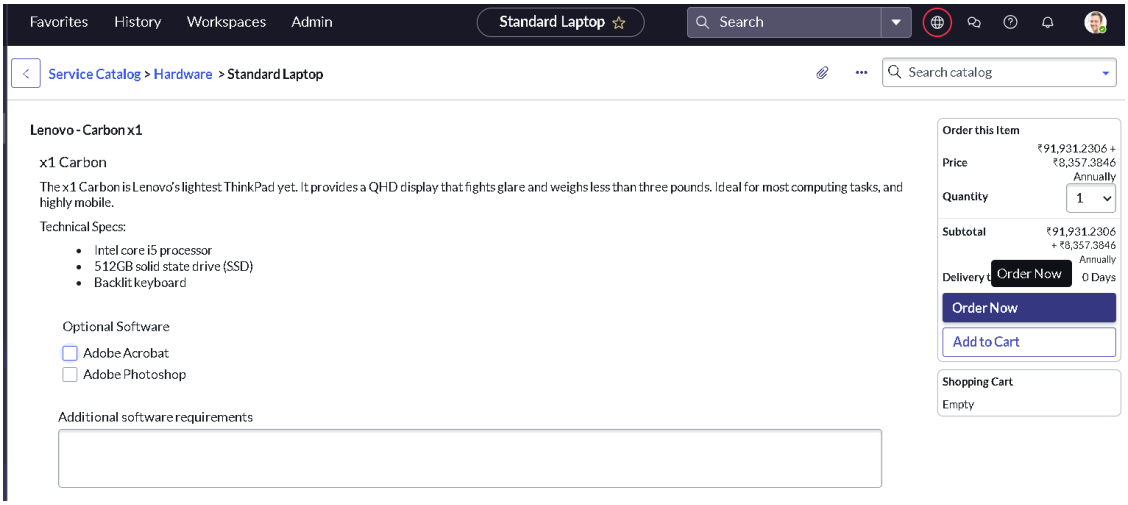


Figure 7.5: Standard Laptop catalog item – Order Now

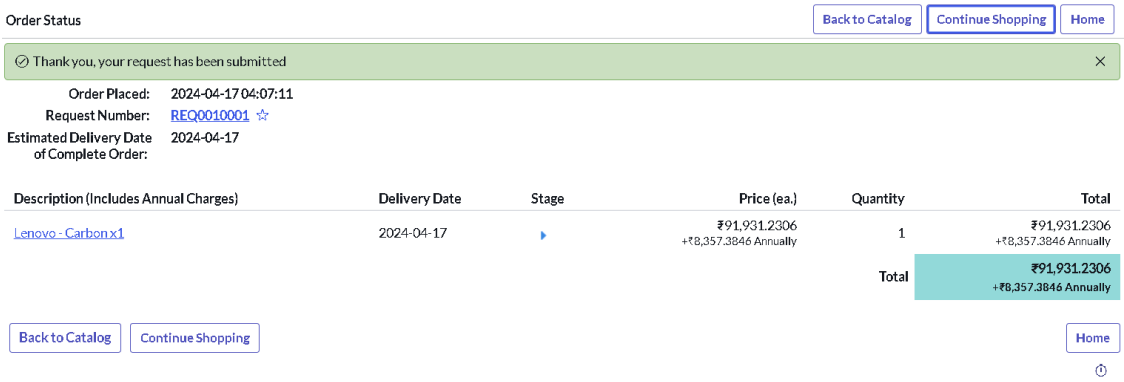


Figure 7.6: Order status with request number REQ0010001

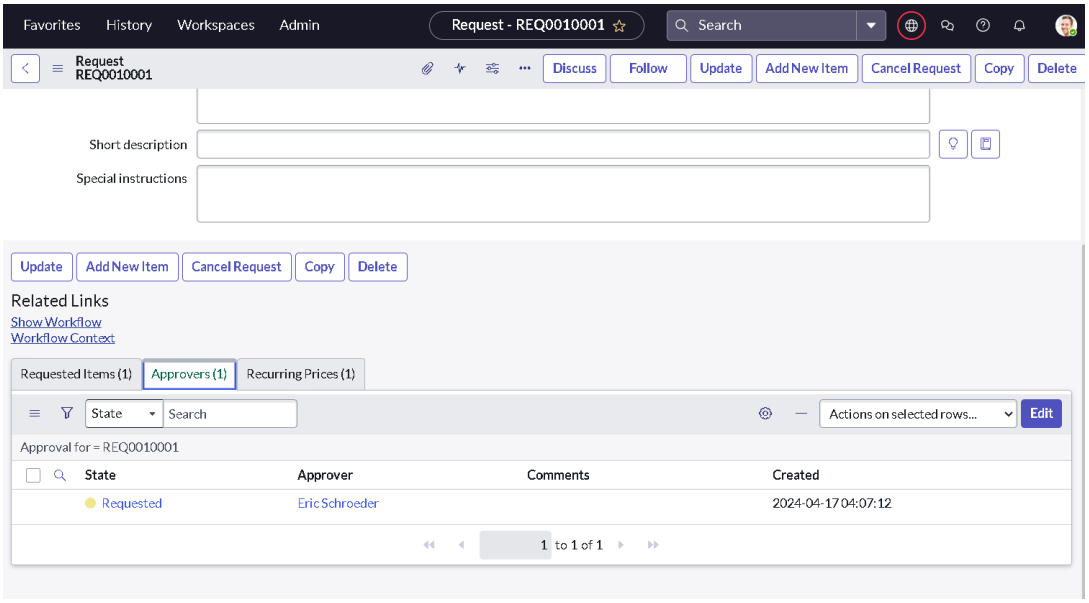


Figure 7.7: Approvers related list on the request

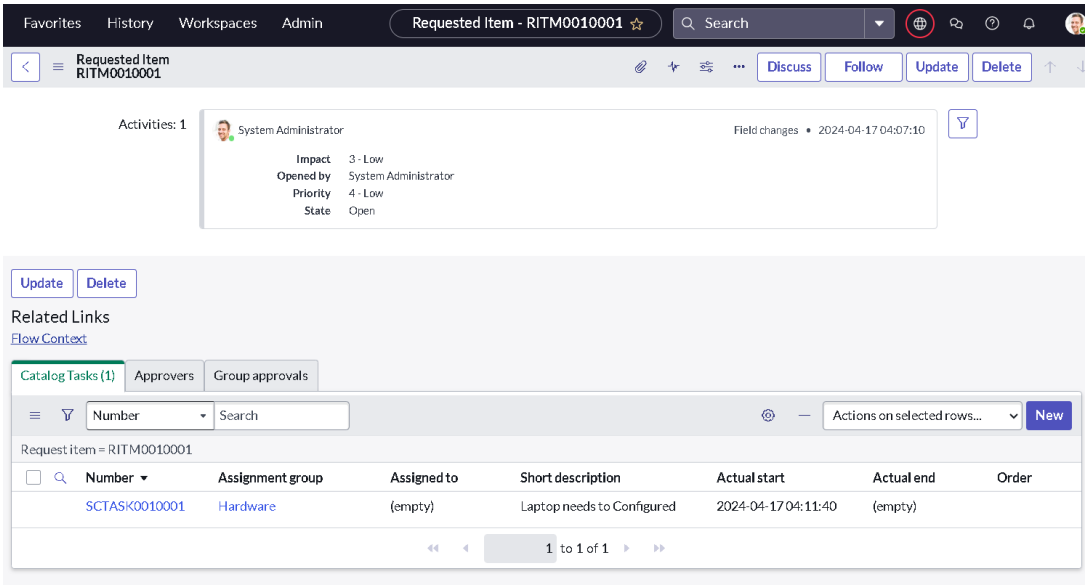


Figure 7.8: Catalog task SCTASK0010001 under RITM0010001

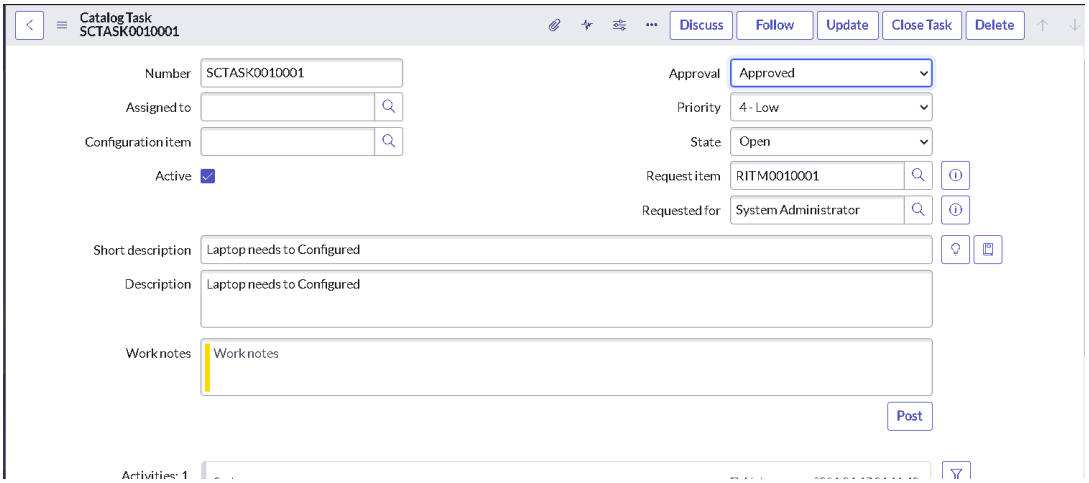


Figure 7.9: Catalog task with short description and approval

8. Advantages & Disadvantages

Advantages	Disadvantages
Catalog task is created automatically	Works for the Standard Laptop item only until extended
Task is assigned to the Hardware team without manual work	Short description text is fixed, not built from request details
Fewer missed or delayed configurations	No notification to the requester yet
Low-code solution, quick to build and change	Needs a ServiceNow instance with Flow Designer
Reusable for other catalog items	

9. Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project addresses the inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. The workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimises user wait times and improves productivity within the IT department. The solution optimises resource allocation and improves the user experience with a seamless and efficient procurement process.

10. Future Scope

- Add an explicit approval step or wait condition inside the flow so task creation is tied directly to approval.
- Send email or notification to the requester and the Hardware team when the task is created.
- Build the short description from request details such as requester name and selected software.
- Add SLA timers and a dashboard for configuration time.
- Extend the same pattern to other items such as monitors, mobile phones and software requests.

11. Appendix

Source code	Not applicable – the solution is configured in Flow Designer (low-code). Flow name: Standard laptop task (Global).
Dataset link	Not applicable
GitHub & Project Demo link	[Add your GitHub / demo video link here]